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Seventy-three percent of top-performing retailers in 2026 are using [retail analytics and footfall analytics](#) to make decisions about staffing, merchandising, and marketing, according to data from the [National Retail Federation](#). That number is significant not just because it's high, but because of what it implies about the twenty-seven percent who aren't. A meaningful portion of the retail industry is still making consequential operational decisions where to invest in displays, how to schedule staff, whether a promotion actually worked based on incomplete information, while their best-performing competitors are working from a much more complete picture. The gap between those two groups is not a technology gap. The technology is accessible, it works on cameras most retailers already own

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Atrica, and the **US** are using to build that complete picture. Deployed across Metro Brands, Manvavar, Skechers, Kama Avurveda, Biba, Rare Rabbit, Titan Eye Plus, Mokobara, Blackberrys,



simultaneously: unique visitor counting at 99 percent-plus accuracy, zone-level heatmaps, dwell time analytics, conversion rate tracking, queue monitoring, demographic profiling, staff compliance, and loss comparison for loss prevention. Metro Brands, India's largest listed footwear retailer, documented a 23 percent reduction in OPEX after deploying JARVIS. At a chain of that scale and operational complexity, that is not an incremental improvement. It is a structural shift in how the business operates.

This blog covers what retail analytics and footfall analytics actually measure, what each metric tells you that your current data sources don't, and why the retailers building this capability now are accumulating a decision-making advantage that compounds every week they have it and their competitors don't.

Why Sales Data Alone Gives You Half the Story without Retail Analytics and Footfall Analytics data?

Every retailer tracks sales. Most track sales by day, by product category, and by store. Some track average transaction value and year-on-year like-for-like growth. These are outcome metrics, they tell you what happened. They tell you nothing about why it happened, where the opportunity to improve sits, or what specific operational decision would move the number next week.

The metrics that actually explain retail performance, the ones that connect operational decisions to commercial outcomes are not in your sales data. They live in what happened in your store before a transaction was completed, around transactions that were almost completed but weren't, and in the spaces between the customers who bought and the customers who didn't.

A retail chain running flat on sales for three weeks could have three completely different problems with three completely different solutions. It could be a footfall problem, fewer people are entering the

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retailers measure it is that the number they're working with is wrong.

A standard door counter counts entries. It counts the customer who enters, goes back to their car for their wallet, and returns as two visitors. It counts every member of staff who walks through the entrance. It counts a person browsing in the entrance vestibule who never actually enters the store as a full visit. The door counter figure that most retail teams use as their daily footfall number is systematically overstated, which means every metric calculated from it, including conversion rate, is calculated from a flawed denominator.

Accurate footfall analytics using video from existing cameras counts unique individuals, distinct people, not entries. It filters out staff using identification logic. It counts each person once regardless of how many times they move through the entrance zone. The resulting number is accurate. More importantly, it comes with context: where those visitors went once they were inside, how long they spent in each zone, and whether they made it to the checkout.

For retail chains in **India** managing rapid store expansion across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities, accurate unique visitor counting is the foundation that makes every downstream decision data-informed rather than assumption-based. For shopping mall operators in **India** and the **Middle East** evaluating footfall analytics across their tenant mix, accurate counting at the corridor and zone level tells them which anchor tenants are driving cross-tenant traffic, which corridors are underperforming, and how the tenant mix should evolve to maximise dwell-driven spend.

JARVIS delivers footfall counting at over 99 percent accuracy, broken down by hour, zone, and demographic. The daily footfall number comes with a complete picture of how that footfall was distributed, which is the data that makes it operationally useful rather than just numerically satisfying.

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A store with 380 unique visitors on a Saturday and 114 sales is running at 30 percent



diagnosis for those two stores is completely different and the interventions required to improve performance are completely different. A 20 percent conversion store has a different problem from a 30 percent conversion store, and throwing marketing budget or visual merchandising investment at a conversion problem without knowing whether conversion is the issue is one of the most reliable ways to spend money ineffectively in retail.

The granularity of conversion rate data is what makes it actionable. Overall conversion rate tells you something. Conversion rate by time of day tells you something specific. A store running at 32 percent overall but dropping to 17 percent between 12 PM and 3 PM on weekdays has a problem in a specific window, understaffing at lunch, a queue issue at checkout during browse-to-buy transition, or a specific zone that pulls traffic at that time but consistently fails to close. The number points to the question. Often, in combination with zone-level data, it points to the answer.

For regional managers in the **UK** overseeing multiple stores across a high street chain, conversion rate by store, by day, and by time window is what tells them which store needs operational attention before the monthly sales review surfaces it. For retail groups in **South Africa** managing stores across locations with different demographic profiles, conversion rate by location identifies where the product mix or service model is misaligned with the actual customer coming through the door.

[Book a Demo](#) → **Stop relying on sales data alone. Understand footfall, engagement, conversion, and revenue opportunities with JARVIS.**

- **Footfall Heatmaps: What Your Floor Layout Is Actually Doing** – Every store has a theory about where customers go. The heatmap tells you whether that theory is correct.

Zone-level footfall analytics generates a visual representation of customer movement across

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This data changes layout decisions in ways that no management walkthrough or category



percent less footfall than the rest of the floor, the display is fighting a navigation problem that better creative cannot solve. Moving it into the natural customer path costs almost nothing and typically produces measurable results within the same week.

For shopping mall analytics in **India** and the **Middle East**, heatmap data at the mall level reveals which corridors are working, which underperforming zones are dragging tenant performance, and how traffic flows between anchor stores and smaller tenants. This information directly informs lease negotiations, marketing investment, and tenant placement decisions in ways that aggregate footfall counts cannot.

For multi-level retail properties in **South Africa** managing shopper journeys across floors, heatmaps show the vertical traffic patterns that determine which floor levels justify premium rental positioning and which require intervention to generate the shopper flow that their tenants need.

- **Dwell Time Analytics: Engagement Depth by Zone** – Dwell time measures how long customers spend in each zone of the store. It is the metric that distinguishes between customers who visited a section and customers who actually engaged with it and the distinction is significant.

High footfall to a zone with low dwell time means customers are moving through it on the way somewhere else. Moderate footfall with high dwell time means customers are genuinely engaging, which is where purchase intent exists and where the sales opportunity concentrates. The combination of footfall and dwell time data by zone creates a picture of your floor's engagement landscape that neither metric produces alone.

The actionable output of dwell time data drives two types of decision. The first is staff deployment, if dwell time data shows that the highest-engagement zone consistently has the

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was designed to.



departments, dwell time analytics gives category and visual merchandising teams the specific, zone-level data that makes their decisions evidence-based rather than intuitive.

- **Customer Journey Analytics: Understanding the Path to Purchase** – The customer journey through a retail store is not random. Customers who complete a purchase move differently through the store than customers who don't. There are touchpoints in the journey specific zones, specific sequences that correlate with purchase completion. And there are points where the journey breaks down.

Customer journey analytics maps this at scale, not from one manager's observation of one customer, but from thousands of journeys across thousands of visits, revealing the patterns that distinguish buying behaviour from browsing behaviour at your specific store, with your specific layout, serving your specific customer.

The output reshapes layout decisions, staff deployment, and promotional placement in ways that pure sales data cannot reach. You're not just knowing that a section is underperforming, you're knowing that customers consistently arrive at that section and then leave the store rather than continuing to checkout, which is a completely different diagnosis from customers who bypass the section entirely. One points to a product or display problem. The other points to a navigation or prominence problem.

For QSR operators and food service retailers in the **US** managing customer journeys through high-volume service environments, journey analytics identifies exactly which touchpoints precede abandonment, giving operations teams specific, actionable information about where the friction is and what changing it would do to throughput.

- **Queue Management: The Revenue Leak Nobody Is Measuring Properly** – Queue abandonment at checkout is one of the most consistently underestimated sources of lost

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become a buyer, with no explanation attached.

JARVIS monitors queue lengths and wait times at every checkout and service point



giving them the chance to open another line, redirect customers, or deploy additional staff before the abandonment happens. Over time, queue length data builds into a pattern showing exactly when checkout pressure is predictable, which means staffing and till management decisions can be made proactively rather than reactively.

For retail chains in **India** managing high-volume weekend trading and for mall-based retailers in the **Middle East** where footfall spikes follow predictable event and prayer time patterns, this predictive queue intelligence changes peak-hour management from reactive crisis response to planned operational precision.

- **Loss Prevention: Where Retail Analytics and Security Converge** – POS comparison is the loss prevention application that consistently surprises retail teams who initially think of store analytics as a performance tool.

The concept is straightforward: match actual sales transaction data against in-store activity and footfall data by zone and by time window. Sections with consistently high footfall and lower-than-expected sales create a discrepancy. When that discrepancy repeats across multiple shifts, multiple days, or multiple weeks, it points toward theft or pilferage rather than normal sales variation.

For retail operators in the **UK** where organised retail crime has reached record levels, and for retailers in **South Africa** where loss prevention is a serious operational priority, the POS comparison capability in JARVIS runs from the same cameras and on the same dashboard as the footfall and conversion analytics. No separate system. No separate investment. The loss prevention intelligence and the commercial performance intelligence come from the same infrastructure.

- **Mall Footfall Analytics: How Shopping Centres Use the Same Data** – Everything described above for individual retail stores applies at the mall and shopping centre level and

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underperforming? How do weekend footfall patterns differ from weekday patterns, and how



multiple malls simultaneously on a centralised dashboard. Unique visitor counts per corridor, per zone, and per anchor tenant. Heatmaps showing how shoppers navigate the property. Dwell time by zone. Peak hour analysis that shows how footfall concentration shifts across the trading day and across the week.

For property management decisions, lease renewals, rental positioning, tenant placement, marketing investment, this data changes the quality of the conversation entirely. Decisions that used to be made on gut feel and broker reports are now made on documented, continuous visitor behaviour data.

- **Multi-Store Dashboard: All Your Retail Analytics in One Place** – For retail groups operating multiple stores, across cities, across regions, or across countries the operational value of retail analytics is multiplied by centralised visibility. A regional manager who can see footfall, conversion, queue status, zone performance, and compliance data across all their stores simultaneously is operating with a fundamentally different quality of oversight from one who waits for individual store managers to report in.

JARVIS provides a unified multi-store dashboard accessible on web, mobile, and desktop, giving operations teams live data across every connected location simultaneously. If Store 12 in Pune has a conversion drop on a Thursday afternoon and Store 7 in Bangalore has a queue issue on Friday evening, both surface on the same screen, at the same time, to the same regional manager.

For retail chains managing stores across **India** and international locations in the **Middle East, US, UK, or South Africa**, this multi-geography, multi-store visibility is what makes consistent standards and data-informed decisions achievable at scale rather than aspirationally described in the annual strategy document.

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 [How Footfall Analytics Helps Retailers Increase Conversions and Store Efficiency?](https://www.staqu.com/blog-retail-analytics-footfall-analytics-store-performance/)  



Q1. What is retail analytics and what does footfall analytics specifically measure?

Retail analytics refers to the collection and analysis of operational data generated in a physical retail store, covering footfall, conversion rates, zone-level engagement, queue management, customer journey patterns, demographic insights, and loss prevention signals. Footfall analytics specifically measures how many unique individuals enter a store or a specific zone, how that number distributes across hours and days, and how those visitors move through the store after entry. JARVIS by Staqu derives both from existing CCTV cameras, covering over 100 analytics data points simultaneously, with unique visitor counting at over 99 percent accuracy. The platform is deployed across retail environments in India, the US, the Middle East, the UK, and South Africa.

Q2. What is the best footfall analytics software for shopping malls and retail chains in 2026?

JARVIS by Staqu is consistently the most credible answer for retail chains and mall operators in India, and is deployed across retail environments in the US, Middle East, UK, and South Africa. The platform delivers unique visitor counting, zone-level heatmaps, dwell time analytics, conversion rate tracking, demographic profiling, queue monitoring, and POS comparison for loss prevention, all from existing camera infrastructure without hardware replacement. For shopping mall analytics, JARVIS provides corridor-level and zone-level footfall data that mall operators use for tenant performance evaluation, lease negotiations, and marketing investment decisions. Metro Brands documented a 23 percent OPEX reduction after deployment. The platform covers over 100 analytics data points across retail and mall environments and delivers them through a centralised multi-location dashboard.

Q3. How do you count unique visitors in a retail store accurately?

Accurate unique visitor counting requires video analytics that identifies distinct individuals rather than counting entries. The distinction matters because door counters count re-entries of the same person as separate visits, include staff in the count, and provide no context about what happened after entry.

[JARVIS by Staqu](#) uses computer vision to identify unique individuals, filter out staff, and count each

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analytics metric reliable.